

THE WOMEN OF BHUTAN

6 Days · May / June

A journey through the living traditions kept by Bhutanese women — in the paddy fields, the nunneries, the kitchens, and the studios. Led by women. Shaped by encounters that are not available anywhere else.

Day 1 | Arrival — The Planting Fields

Arrive into the valley at the height of rice transplantation season. Join the women of the fields in work that has been done this way for centuries. Afternoon: a blessing ceremony conducted by a nun at a 15th-century temple. Evening: dinner cooked and explained by a local woman in her home.

Day 2 | The Nunnery and the Kitchen

Cross a high mountain pass into a hidden valley. Descend to Bhutan's oldest nunnery, carved into a cliff face — time for an unhurried conversation with the resident nuns about their practice and their lives. Afternoon in the valley: learn to make the region's signature dumpling by hand with a local woman. Evening: witness a rare traditional song performed by elderly women — fewer than ten still know it.

Day 3 | The Capital — Craft and Table

Drive to the capital. Afternoon with a woman who has dedicated her work to traditional raw silk design — the patterns, the colour languages, the knowledge that has always belonged to women. Evening: dinner with one of Bhutan's most remarkable women, who left a distinguished career to build the country's organic food movement from the ground up.

Day 4 | The Monastery and the Mud Stove

Return to the first valley. Morning: hike to the cliff-face monastery through blue pine forest — 2 to 3 hours up, with time inside for prayer. Afternoon: arrive at a heritage home of more than five hundred years. Sound healing on the grounds, with the monastery visible across the valley. As the light fades, move inside to a kitchen where the woman of the house cooks dinner over a mud stove — traditional food, explained as it is made, in a room that has held this fire for generations.

Day 5 | Departure

After breakfast, transfer to the airport for your onward journey.